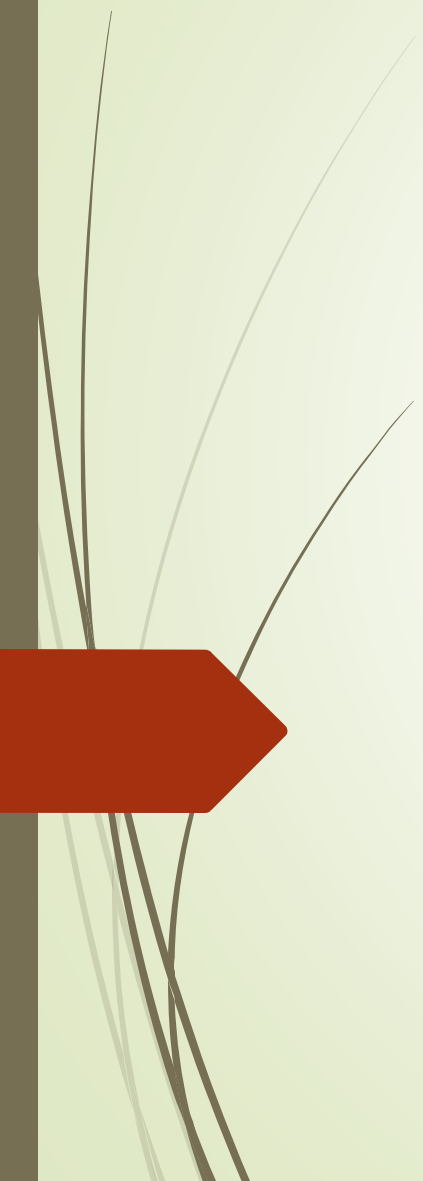




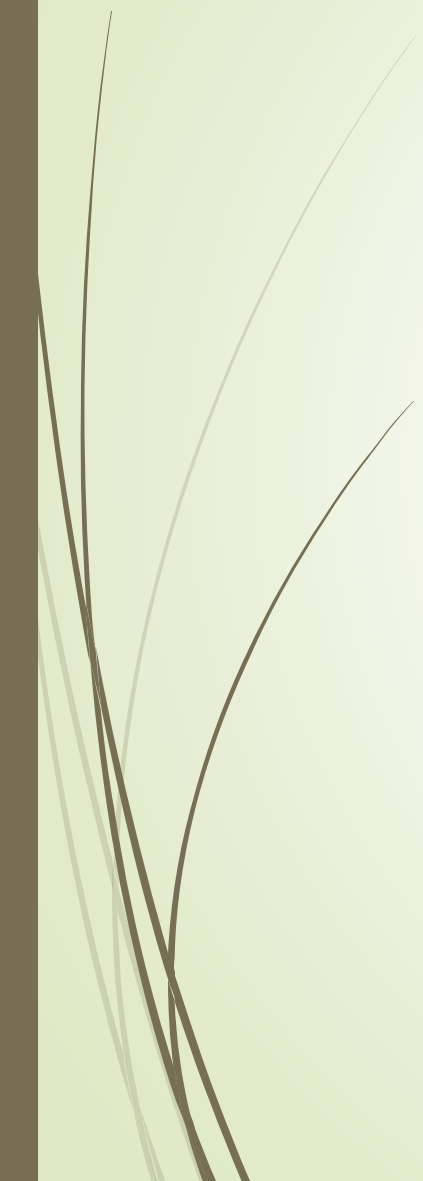
Lawrence Kohlberg's Theory of Moral Development

Engineering Ethics - Moral Psychology

Presented by: Dr. Razib Hayat Khan



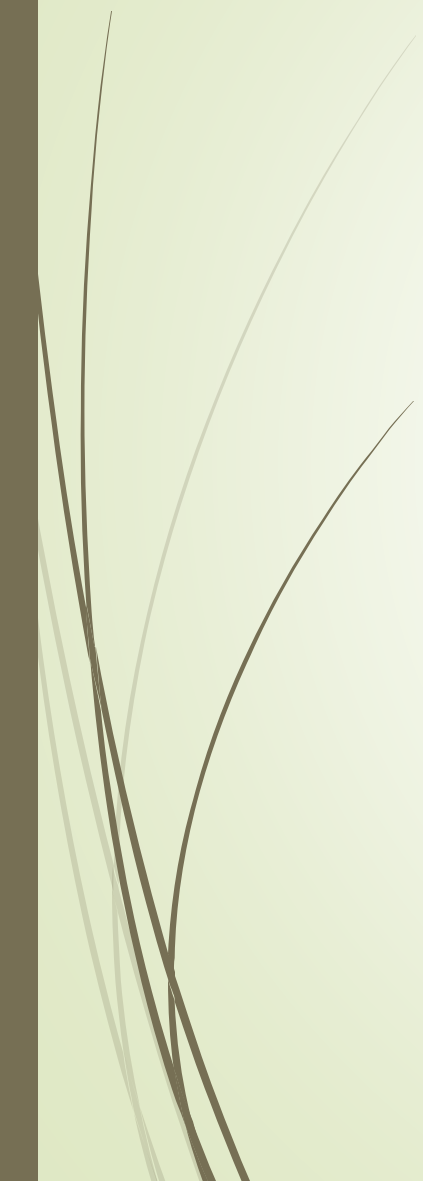
Introduction



- Lawrence Kohlberg was a professor at Harvard University known for his work on developmental psychology.
- He developed a theory of moral development based on the ideas of Piaget, Dewey, and Baldwin.



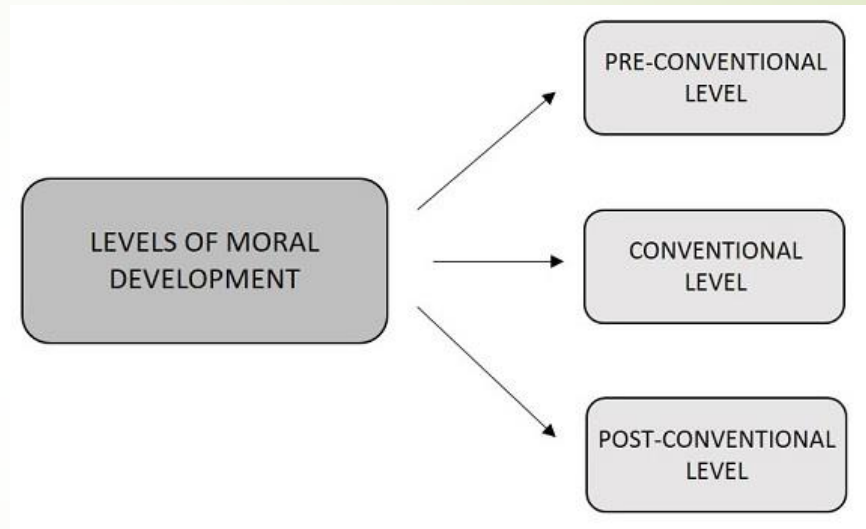
Kohlberg's Theory Overview

- Kohlberg proposed that moral reasoning develops through a progressive sequence of stages.
 - Moral judgments evolve from consequences in early childhood to justice in adulthood.
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Three Levels of Moral Development

1. Pre-conventional Level
2. Conventional Level
3. Post-conventional Level

➔ Each level consists of two sub-stages of moral reasoning.



Pre-conventional Level

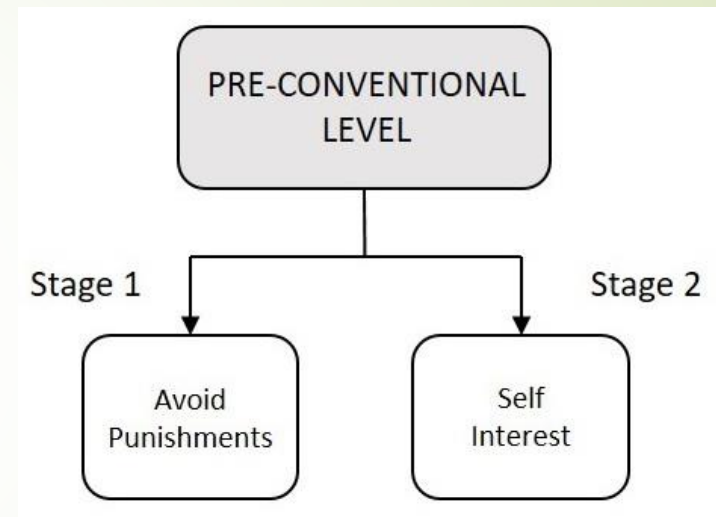
- Found at the elementary school level. Focus is on direct consequences of actions.

Stage 1: Avoid Punishment

- Obedience to authority to avoid punishment.

Stage 2: Self-interest

- Right behavior means acting in one's own best interest.



Conventional Level

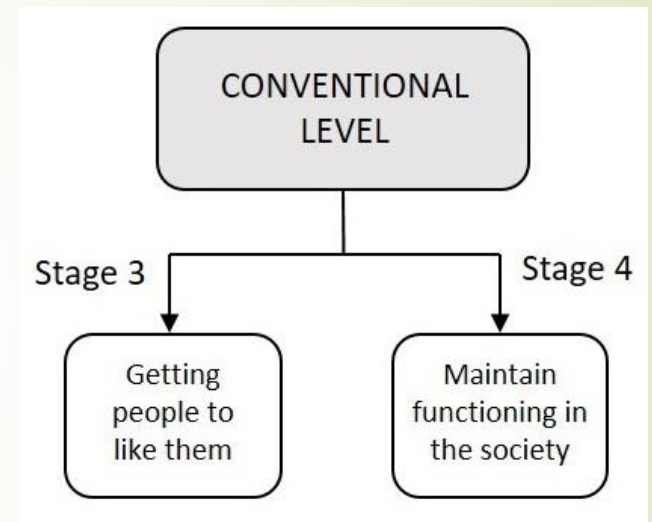
- Common at primary and high school levels. Focus is on pleasing others and maintaining order.

Stage 3: Getting People to Like Them

- Behavior guided by desire to gain approval.

Stage 4: Maintain Functioning in Society

- Following rules for the benefit of society.



Post-conventional Level

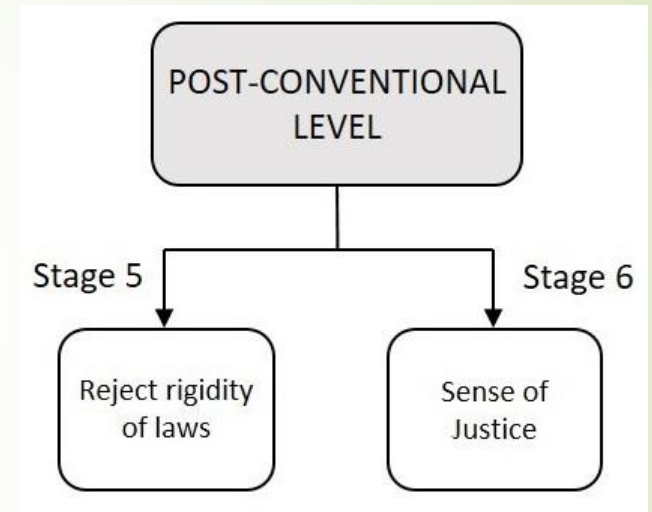
- Typically found in adulthood. Focus is on universal principles and justice.

Stage 5: Reject Rigidity of Laws

- Emphasis on moral reasoning over strict laws.

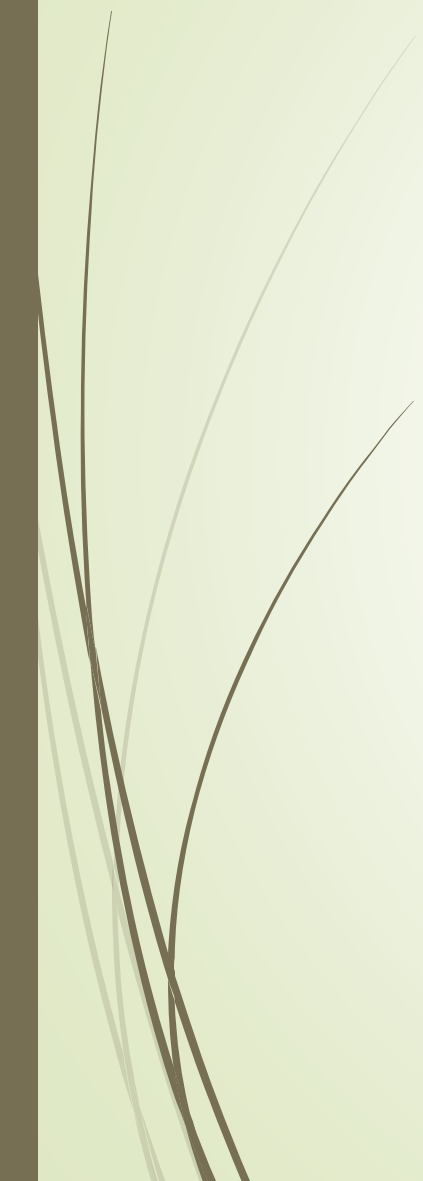
Stage 6: Sense of Justice

- Guided by inner ethical principles, regardless of external influence.





Moral Judgment Process

- Judgment is made by the thinker about the protagonist in a scenario.
 - Each stage reflects how the thinker evaluates right and wrong.
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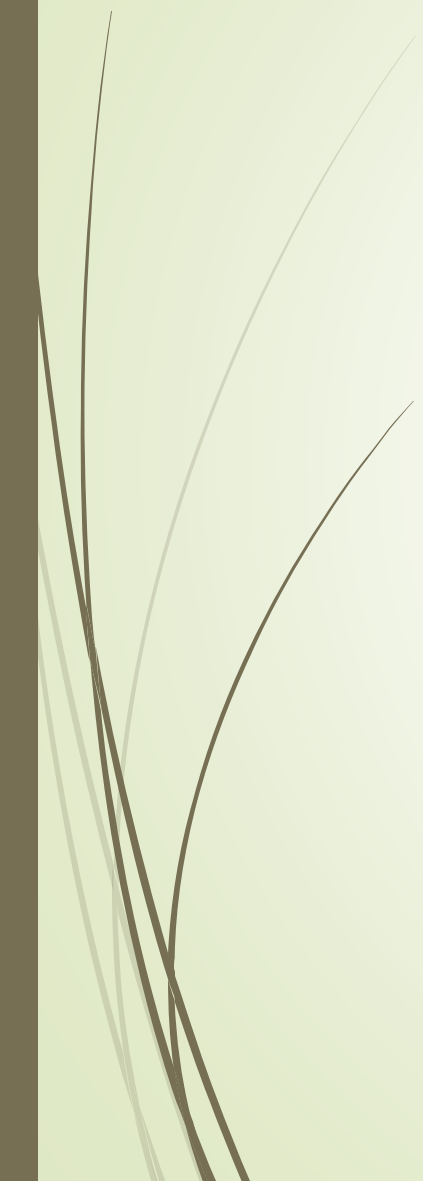


Summary of Kohlberg's Theory

- Six stages across three levels
- From obedience and punishment to justice and universal ethics
- Moral development reflects how individuals understand and apply ethics over time.



Conclusion

- Kohlberg's theory emphasizes the evolution of ethical thinking.
 - It is foundational in understanding moral reasoning in engineering ethics and beyond.
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HEINZ'S DILEMMA

A Case Study in Moral Development

Based on Lawrence Kohlberg's Theory

Presented by: Dr. Razib Hayat Khan



THE STORY OF HEINZ

- Heinz is a middle-aged, ordinary man with a seriously ill wife.
- A newly invented drug can save her, but it costs \$2,000 while only costing \$20 to produce.
- Heinz can only collect \$1,000 despite his best efforts.
- The drug-seller refuses to lower the price.



HEINZ'S DILEMMA

- With no other option, Heinz considers stealing the drug to save his wife.
- What should he do?
- This moral dilemma forms the basis for analyzing ethical reasoning.



THINKER'S OPTIONS

- Heinz should not steal the drug because it breaks the law.
- Heinz can steal the drug but should be punished.
- Heinz can steal the drug and should not be punished.



OPTION 1: OBEY THE LAW

- Heinz does not steal the drug.
- His wife dies; the drug-seller profits.
- Law is obeyed, but moral justice is not served.
- This reflects ****Pre-Conventional**** moral thinking.



OPTION 2: STEAL AND FACE PUNISHMENT

- Heinz saves his wife.
- He accepts the legal punishment.
- A moral decision is made, but justice is partial.
- This reflects ****Conventional**** moral thinking.



OPTION 3: STEAL WITHOUT PUNISHMENT

- Heinz saves his wife and avoids punishment.
- The decision is made on moral grounds, rejecting rigid law.
- This reflects ****Post-Conventional**** moral thinking.



IMPLICATIONS OF HEINZ'S DILEMMA

- The dilemma challenges thinkers to balance law and morality.
- The choice reveals the stage of moral development.
- Encourages deeper reflection on ethical reasoning.



CONCLUSION

- Heinz's dilemma illustrates Kohlberg's levels of moral development in real-life context.
- The responses to this scenario highlight different ethical reasoning paths individuals take.
- What would you choose, and what does that say about your moral development?

